

Triple trouble

Sometimes, three words sound very similar but mean different things. In such cases, be extra careful to understand the differences between the three words and learn the spellings.

though

This means the same as the word *however*.

or

through

This means into one end and out of the other.

or

thorough

This refers to something that is well done or complete.

He still wanted to go shopping, **though**.

He walked **through** the crowd.

He conducted a **thorough** investigation.

quit

This means to leave, usually permanently.

or

quiet

This refers to making little or no noise.

or

quite

This usually refers to the greatest extent or degree.

The journalist **quit** her job at the newspaper.

It seemed eerily **quiet** along the street.

The story made **quite** an impression on her.

More confused meanings

There are many examples of words that are widely and repeatedly misspelled because their meanings are not clearly understood. Always reread the sentence to make sure the correct word is used.

Word	Example
accident	The bicycle accident left her with a large bruise.
angel	The religious text mentioned an angel .
desert	It was very hot in the middle of the desert .
elicit	The father tried to elicit a response from his son.
envelop	The fog was about to envelop the town.
lightening	The hairdresser was lightening my hair.
rational	There was no rational reason for her behavior.

Word	Example
incident	There was an incident of bullying on the team.
angle	Every angle in a square is the same size.
dessert	My favorite dessert is key lime pie.
illicit	The airport confiscated illicit food from the man.
envelope	He put the letter in an envelope .
lightning	The lightning storm caused havoc.
rationale	She explained the rationale for her decision.

REAL WORLD

Funny puns

Tabloid newspapers are renowned for their use of puns in headlines. Puns take advantage of the potential confusion between words that sound the same to create jokes or wry commentary.

